

Recovery Protocols and Active Recovery

Reference notes on general recovery practices between training sessions. Paraphrased from mainstream sports-science and exercise-physiology guidance. Not medical advice.

The idea of active vs. passive recovery

Passive recovery means minimal movement (rest days, sleep, stretching). Active recovery means low-intensity movement such as easy walking, light cycling, swimming, or mobility work, generally performed at an intensity where a conversation is easy to hold.

Light active recovery can help by increasing blood flow to worked muscles, which may reduce the perception of soreness and keep a routine of daily movement, without adding meaningful additional training stress.

When active recovery is appropriate

- Recovery score or readiness is moderate rather than very low.
- The person feels generally fatigued or mildly sore but has no pain, illness, or injury symptoms.
- The goal is to maintain a routine while allowing harder-trained muscle groups to recover.

When full rest is more appropriate than active recovery

- Recovery score is low across multiple consecutive days.
- There are signs of illness, unusual fatigue, or elevated resting heart rate well above the person's baseline.
- Sleep has been significantly reduced for several nights in a row.
- The person reports pain (as opposed to normal muscle soreness) in a joint or muscle.

A simple day-after-hard-training checklist

- Prioritize sleep quantity and consistency the night after a hard session.
- Rehydrate and eat adequate protein and carbohydrate to support tissue repair and glycogen replenishment.
- Use light movement (walking, easy cycling, mobility) rather than complete inactivity, unless full rest is indicated.
- Avoid stacking another high-intensity session on top of unresolved soreness, poor sleep, and low HRV at the same time.

Framing recovery for the assistant's responses

Recovery suggestions should be framed as general lifestyle and training-load guidance, not medical treatment. The assistant should describe what a given recovery score typically calls for (active recovery, easy training, or full rest) and explain briefly why, using the day's metrics as the reasoning.